

Shoot: To depress the shutter release button of the camera to take a photograph.

Short-focal-length lens (wide angle): A lens that provides a wide angle of view of a scene, including more of the subject area than does a lens of normal focal length.

Shutter: A mechanical device on a camera that opens and closes to control the time of a photographic exposure.

Shutter Release: The mechanism, usually a button on the top of the camera, which activates the shutter to expose the film.

Shutter Speed: The length of time the shutter is open and light strikes the image sensor.

Shutter-priority mode: An automatic exposure system in which you set the shutter speed and the camera selects the aperture (f-stop) for correct exposure.

SLR: An SLR or single-lens reflex is really designed for the enthusiast photographer or the person who can put up with a larger camera in return for increased accuracy and greater versatility. This type of camera has through the lens viewing with a mirror behind the lens and a pentaprism to direct the light passing through the lens to the optical finder. The mirror lifts up out of the way as a photograph is taken. As you look through the lens that takes the picture the composition can be more accurate and the lens often removes giving you a wider scope of options. The metering and focusing systems are usually more accurate too.

SmartMedia: A popular form of flash memory card.

Software Package: A computer application program delivered to the user in a complete and ready-to-run form, including all necessary utility programs and documentation.

Spot Metering: Autoexposure based on a meter reading of a small circle in the center of the viewfinder.